

The Five-Minute Brief | Stephanie Rader & Greg Calnon: Key Themes in Public & Private Markets

Speakers: Matt Gibson (Head of Client Solutions Group), Greg Calnon (Head of Public Investing), Stephanie Rader (Co-Head of Alternatives Capital Formation)

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Transcript

00:00:00 – 00:00:07 **Greg Calnon**

This is a great time to be an investor. There's so much dislocation within markets. And that's not always fun, but it's a great time.

00:00:11 – 00:00:47 **Matt Gibson**

Hi, I'm Matt Gibson, head of the Client Solutions Group for Goldman Sachs Asset Management. This is The Five-Minute Brief, which gives you a glimpse into my conversations with leaders from across Goldman Sachs as we discuss what is top of mind for our clients as they navigate the global financial markets. Today, I'm excited to be joined by the head of Public Investing, Greg Calnon, and the global co-head of Alternatives Capital Formation, Stephanie Rader. Good morning, Steph and Greg. It's great to have both of you here to represent the private and the public markets. To start, what are the most significant secular themes defining the long-term outlook for both public and private markets?

00:00:47 – 00:01:54 **Greg Calnon**

Well, Matt, this is a moment of short-term market stress in an otherwise constructive macro backdrop. The market is really doing what it always does. It's trying to find winners and losers. It's doing this in AI. It's doing this as geopolitical events unfold in the Middle East. It's also doing this as every day we get additional sort of macroeconomic data. And there's also a little bit of, I would say, indiscriminatory behavior where you're really selling everything and trying to figure out what's going on later. And so, we're seeing all of that short-term stress going on in markets when playing out on a day-to-day basis. We're in a world where earnings continue to be, you know, stronger and stronger on a quarter-to-quarter basis. So, this quarter, for example, the expectation for earnings was something like 8 percent growth and we had something closer to 12 percent. So, again, companies are continuing to do well. The economy is generally continuing to do well. We have a tremendous amount of AI investment and capital expenditure. So, these are themes that are playing out in markets, rippling through the whole economy. And we're really seeing this play out in a material way.

00:01:54 – 00:02:01 **Matt Gibson**

Yeah, totally agree. Steph, maybe moving over to you. What do you see as the most significant secular themes driving private markets?

00:02:01 – 00:03:03 Stephanie Rader

Yeah, so there are a few very powerful secular themes in private markets. And I'd say first the most obvious is AI and automation. And while productivity is positive, I think, you know, dislocation may be stabilizing. So, I think there may be a wide range of outcomes before we narrow down on our AI journey. The second thing, big thing, is energy transition. And that lends itself to investments in infrastructure and project finance. We also have an aging demographic which is going to lead to private capital to invest in health care and life sciences. We have deglobalization and supply chain onshoring as well as just massive data infrastructure and the compute economy which is going to require massive physical infrastructure. You know these trends are structural. They're multi-decade and you know they're going to influence capital flows, innovation, valuations, policy. So overall I think the world is entering into a higher level of capital intensity. You know that favors private markets in particular in asset classes like private credit, private equity, and infrastructure.

00:03:03 – 00:03:12 Matt Gibson

In a time where alpha is increasingly being found outside of traditional exchanges, how should investors rethink the role of illiquidity in their portfolio?

00:03:12 – 00:04:32 Stephanie Rader

Most companies are private. They're staying private for longer. And one consequence is public investors miss early growth as most valuation creation happens before the IPO. And this has led to many institutions increasing this allocation to private equity and buyout and growth and venture. But private investments depend heavily on the exit, the IPO, an acquisition, a secondary sale. And so, as we've seen a slowdown in IPOs and M&A, duration has extended, clients have gotten less distributions. But this has led to an opportunity for investments in other areas and to provide for capital to be liquidity solutions. And so, one place is in secondaries. We saw about \$120 billion of LP-led sale volume last year in 2025. That was up 44 percent year over year. And 60 percent of those LPs were repeat sellers. So, we're seeing LPs embrace secondaries as a core portfolio optimization tool. You're also seeing GPs utilize continuation vehicles more, both in private equity and in their private credit portfolios, as well as structured liquidity solutions. And they're using that as head of fundraising for their next vintage.

00:04:32 – 00:05:04 Greg Calnon

I might add, I mean, this is a great time to be an investor. Right? There's so much dislocation within markets that it's not always fun, but it's a great time, right? Because it gives you a lot of opportunities to take advantage of the skill that you've built up over, you know, many decades of investing. It allows an organization like ours that has deep, you know, diligence practices, strong risk management to be able to take advantage of that broader ecosystem to really be making great investment decisions. And that's, you know, a tremendous opportunity for us right now. And so, it's a great time.

00:05:04 – 00:05:08 Matt Gibson

And to your point, Greg, the word volatility is often used in a negative connotation. But in a way—

00:05:08 – 00:05:08 Greg Calnon

It's opportunity.

00:05:08 – 00:05:11 Matt Gibson

As an investor, it's a real opportunity to create alpha.

00:05:11 – 00:05:26 **Greg Calnon**

Yes. There's so much dispersion that's going on in markets within industries, across industries. It's really the time where having a disciplined approach, a strong investment process, will result in better outcomes for our clients.

00:05:26 – 00:05:32 **Matt Gibson**

Well, thank you both for joining me today. This has been a great kind of walk through of the public/private intersection.

00:05:32 – 00:05:32 **Greg Calnon**

Great.

00:05:32 – 00:05:32 **Stephanie Rader**

Thank you.

00:05:32 – 00:05:33 **Greg Calnon**

Good to be with you.

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